

CHAUBANDI

KNOTS OF TRADITION

Phase 2 Discovery - Building the Next Phase
Stakeholder Questionnaire - 20 Questions

Prepared for: Sushma & team | Meeting date: 2026-06-20

Purpose: Align on WHAT we build next and HOW we build it - scope, platform, commerce, customization, AI try-on, bridal services, and budget.

How to use this document

Questions are grouped into 10 themes (2 each). Each question includes a short 'why it matters' note grounded in current market research, plus space to capture decisions. Aim for a clear owner and a rough priority (Now / Next / Later) per item.

Where we are today (locked findings)

- High-fidelity marketing prototype: Vite + React, single-file app, no backend.
- 12 hardcoded products (\$159-\$599); only lehengas & sarees have real photos.
- Cart, checkout, payments, contact form & orders are all simulated.
- 'Virtual Try-On' is a label that routes to a WhatsApp video-call booking - not AR.
- Strengths: beautiful brand, story, reviews, WhatsApp-first, bridal positioning.

Market context (from June 2026 research)

- AI virtual try-on is becoming standard: reported ~25% higher conversion and ~40% fewer returns; modern 2D-image solutions no longer need 3D assets.
- Made-to-measure leaders (GetEthnic, Andaaz, UDesign) win with reference-photo uploads, 3D sketches, and guided measurement + virtual consultations.
- Online bridal appointment booking is now a baseline expectation.
- Platform: for brands under ~\$5M revenue, standard Shopify usually beats headless on ROI; headless pays off for configurators, AR and deep personalization.

1. Vision & Business Goals

- Q1. What is the #1 goal for the next phase - sell online at scale, generate qualified bridal leads, or showcase the brand to drive in-store visits?**

Why it matters: This single decision reorders every other priority below (full commerce vs. lead-gen vs. brand).

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

- Q2. What does success look like in 6 and 12 months, and which 2-3 numbers will we track (orders, booked consultations, AOV, return rate, IG-to-site traffic)?**

Why it matters: Concrete KPIs let us scope features against payback rather than wish-lists.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

2. Platform & Technology

- Q3. Do we keep building the custom React app, or move to Shopify (or similar) for real payments, inventory and orders?**

Why it matters: Below ~\$5M revenue, standard Shopify typically returns more than a custom/headless build; custom only pays off for unique configurators/AR.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

- Q4. Who maintains the site after launch, and what is our tolerance for ongoing monthly cost vs. one-time build cost?**

Why it matters: Maintenance ownership drives the platform choice as much as features do.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

3. Commerce & Catalog

- Q5. How many real products will we launch with, and who owns photography, pricing, inventory counts and descriptions?**

Why it matters: Today there are 12 hardcoded items with mostly placeholder imagery; real catalog data is the gating dependency for any store.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

Q6. Which payment methods and shipping/returns rules must we support at launch (cards, Apple/Google Pay, PayPal, Zelle; US-only or international)?

Why it matters: Checkout, tax and returns logic are currently simulated and must be made real.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

4. Customization & Made-to-Measure

Q7. Will we offer made-to-measure/custom orders online, and if so via guided measurements, reference-photo upload, or video consult only?

Why it matters: Custom tailoring is Chaubandi's differentiator; competitors win with reference-photo uploads + 3D sketches + guided measurement.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

Q8. How do we handle fit, alterations and the 'no returns on custom' policy in the online flow so expectations are clear before payment?

Why it matters: Clear pre-purchase fit guidance is what reduces disputes and returns for ethnic wear.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

5. Virtual Try-On & AI

Q9. Do we want a real AI virtual try-on (garment-on-shopper image), and is it a launch feature or a fast-follow?

Why it matters: VTO drives the biggest conversion/return-rate gains but adds cost and a vendor dependency; today it is only a label.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

Q10. Are we open to AI styling/recommendations (outfit pairing, occasion-based discovery, size guidance) powered by our catalog?

Why it matters: AI styling lifts AOV and confidence; it needs structured product data to work.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

6. Bridal & Appointments

Q11. Should online appointment booking (in-store + video) become a real calendar with confirmations, instead of a WhatsApp message?

Why it matters: Online bridal booking is now a baseline expectation and captures leads 24/7.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

Q12. What is the ideal bridal journey end-to-end (inspiration -> consult -> custom design -> fittings -> delivery), and which steps go online?

Why it matters: Mapping the journey tells us which features are essential vs. nice-to-have.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

7. Content, Community & Trust

Q13. How do we keep reviews, ratings and the Instagram/UGC reels real and auto-updating instead of hardcoded?

Why it matters: Authentic, fresh social proof is a top conversion driver and is currently static.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

Q14. Do we want customer accounts (saved measurements, order history, wishlist, reorders) at launch?

Why it matters: Accounts enable retention and personalization but add scope and privacy duties.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

8. Marketing, SEO & Retention

Q15. What are our top acquisition channels (Instagram, Google, referrals) and should the site capture zero-party data (email/phone, style quiz)?

Why it matters: For sub-\$5M brands, CRO + acquisition often out-returns a platform rebuild.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

Q16. Do we want loyalty/'Chaubandi Cash', referrals, and email/SMS automation in Phase 2 or later?

Why it matters: Retention mechanics compound over time; deciding the timing affects platform choice.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

9. Operations & Fulfillment

Q17. How are orders received, shipped and tracked today, and what should be automated (labels, tracking emails, inventory sync)?

Why it matters: Manual ops cap how many orders the site can realistically take.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

Q18. Who handles customer support across WhatsApp, phone, email and site chat, and what response time do we promise?

Why it matters: Support load scales with traffic; the model affects staffing and tooling.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

10. Scope, Budget & Timeline

Q19. What is the realistic budget range and hard deadline (e.g., a wedding season or campaign) for Phase 2?

Why it matters: Budget + deadline convert the wish-list into a phased, buildable plan.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

Q20. If we can only ship THREE things first, what are they - and what explicitly waits for Phase 3?

Why it matters: Forcing a top-3 prevents scope creep and gets a real, revenue-ready release out faster.

Owner: _____ Priority: ☐ Now ☐ Next ☐ Later

Parking Lot / Open Questions

Recommended next step

Leave the meeting with: (1) the #1 goal, (2) platform decision, (3) the top-3 launch features with owners, and (4) a budget range + deadline. That is enough to produce a costed Phase 2 build plan.